

The best-known form is Wicca—modern witchcraft drawing loosely on a pre-Christian era. Its growth from the 1950s spurred an interest in ancient beliefs and practices that have spawned movements such as Neoshamanism and Stregheria. All Neopagan orders champion oneness with the natural world, and most are peaceable (apart from a few groups who promote a far-right agenda). Some modern offshoots are professedly self-serving, notably Satanism and Chaos Magic, both intent on personal fulfillment.

Movements that look to the future are loosely known as New Age, or Mind, Body, and Spirit—the pursuit of mental and physical harmony through holistic means such as yoga, meditation, crystal healing, and color therapy. The resulting whole is a form of updated folk magic, which aims to heal what practitioners see as the unnatural excesses of the 21st century. New Age has a natural counterpart in a new type of millennial witch: a self-proclaimed activist sisterhood of technopagans empowered by social media.

“Words and magic were in the beginning one and the same thing, and even today words retain much of their magical power.”

SIGMUND FREUD, *INTRODUCTORY LECTURES ON PSYCHO-ANALYSIS*, 1922



Peruvian healer's vision see p.283



Satanic Baphomet statue see p.288



African Voodoo dancer see p.293